

Develop with a job in mind

Opening Decisions

THE IDEA

Development means bringing pieces into useful play. A piece is not well developed merely because it left its starting square. Its destination should influence the center, help king safety, support a break, or restrain the opponent.

WORKED EXAMPLE

After 1.e4 e5, 2.Nf3 attacks e5 and helps White castle. It develops with a purpose. A move such as 2.Nh3 also moves a knight, but usually contributes less to central play and may need another move later.

TRY IT BEFORE READING ON

What question should accompany every developing move?

ANSWER AND REASONING

What useful task does this piece perform on its new square, and can the opponent chase it while gaining time? Several developing moves may be sound; compare their jobs.

TAKE THIS INTO YOUR NEXT GAME

Develop toward tasks, not just away from the back rank.